

Plumbing Systems

Texas Real Estate Commission Standards of Practice · **22 TAC 535.231** · For the TREC state exam (25 questions, pass at 75%)

Three subsections, and one of them — hydro-massage equipment — is a Texas particularity worth knowing simply because it has its own rule.

The three subsections

- **(a)** Plumbing Systems — supply, drains, vents, fixtures
- **(b)** Water Heaters
- **(c)** Hydro-Massage Therapy Equipment

(a) Plumbing Systems

Covers the water supply and distribution system, drains, waste and vents, and fixtures. The inspector reports the **type of supply and drain piping** and reports deficiencies in condition, operation, leaks and cross-connections.

Carry over the general limitation: anything **buried, hidden, latent or concealed** is outside the standard, which excludes most underground supply and drain lines.

(b) Water Heaters

The classic examinable items are the ones you already know technically — the **temperature and pressure relief valve and its discharge piping**, combustion air and venting for fuel-fired units, seismic or strapping requirements where applicable, and the condition and operation of the unit.

Your national-exam knowledge transfers directly here. The difference is the Texas framing: the rule asks *what you must report as Deficient*, not what the correct installation is.

(c) Hydro-Massage Therapy Equipment

Whirlpool and jetted tubs. The inspector operates the equipment and reports deficiencies, including access to the pump and the presence of GFCI protection.

Why it gets its own subsection: it is a plumbing fixture with an electric motor sitting in water, so it straddles two systems. Texas gives it dedicated treatment rather than leaving it to the fixtures rule.

The mental model for this whole section

Every plumbing subsection resolves to three questions: **what type is it, does it operate, and is anything leaking or unsafe?** Type, operation, condition. If a question asks you to determine adequacy, sizing or the condition of anything buried, the answer is that it is outside the standard.

Check Yourself

1. Which plumbing item has its own subsection because it spans two systems?

Hydro-massage therapy equipment — a water fixture with an electric motor.

2. Are underground supply lines within the standard?

No. Anything buried, hidden, latent or concealed is excluded by the general limitations.

3. What three things does each plumbing subsection come down to?

Type, operation, condition.

Content follows the official TREC Standards of Practice, 22 TAC 535.227-535.233. Rules are amended periodically — verify against the current version on trec.texas.gov before the exam.